

Transit Administration (FTA), the Federal Highway Administration (FHWA), and DRPT participate as nonvoting members.

The TAC is composed of staff representatives from the member jurisdictions, Secretary of Transportation, PAT, and Crater PDC. It provides technical support and serves in an advisory capacity to the Policy Committee. Representatives from Fort Lee, RideFinders, and the National Park Service at Petersburg National Battlefield participate as advisory, nonvoting members given their importance to transportation in the Tri-Cities region.

Regional and state transportation and air quality planning agencies have executed Memoranda of Agreement pursuant to 23 CFR 450.310, defining the roles and responsibilities of each participating agency. During the long-range planning process, TCAMPO and Richmond Regional Transportation Planning Organization (RRTPO) develop an accompanying Conformity Report to comply with metropolitan transportation and air quality planning requirements.

Purpose of the Plan

Plan2050 is TCAMPO's Long Range Transportation Plan (LRTP). Also known as a Metropolitan Transportation Plan (MTP), Plan2050 is a federally required document that establishes the vision, goals, and multimodal investment priorities for the Tri-Cities region's transportation system. As TCAMPO's core long-range planning document, Plan2050 creates a strategic framework for decision-making across the region, guiding investments that improve mobility, safety, equity, and economic development over the next 20 years. Plan2050 provides the basis from which shorter-range programming documents, such as the Metropolitan Transportation Improvement Program (MTIP), will be developed. Consistent with federal requirements, projects must be in the MPO's current approved LRTP to be eligible for federal transportation funding. Federal regulations also require that the LRTP address a planning horizon of at least 20 years and is fiscally constrained. This means that Plan2050 includes only projects and programs for which a reasonable funding source can be identified. Plan2050 ensures that investments in its transportation network are coordinated, strategic, and aligned with the goals of the communities it serves.

Role of TCAMPO

TCAMPO is responsible for carrying out the federally mandated continuing, comprehensive, and cooperative (3C) planning process on behalf of the region's member jurisdictions. In this role, TCAMPO coordinates regional transportation planning, prioritizes investments, and ensures that federal transportation funds are directed toward projects that reflect the needs and priorities of the Tri-Cities region. In addition to the LRTP, TCAMPO develops and maintains the following federally required planning products:

- Unified Planning Work Program (UPWP) – updated annually
- Metropolitan Transportation Plan (MTP) – updated every four years
- Metropolitan Transportation Improvement Program (MTIP) – updated every four years
- Congestion Management Process (CMP) maintained on an ongoing basis

TCAMPO also maintains a Public Participation Plan and Title VI Compliance Plan in accordance with federal public involvement and civil rights requirements (23 CFR 450.316; 49 U.S.C. 5332). Together, these planning products establish the region's transportation priorities, which in turn guide TCAMPO's role in selecting and recommending projects for federal funding, including the Surface Transportation Block Grant (STBG), Congestion Mitigation and Air Quality (CMAQ), and Transportation Alternatives Program (TAP). Beyond federal allocations, TCAMPO also evaluates and recommends projects through Virginia's SMART SCALE prioritization process and provides technical assistance to its member jurisdictions in developing competitive applications.

Federal Regional Transportation Planning Requirements

Federal law requires that transportation plans in urbanized areas with a population of 50,000 or more be developed through the 3C planning process (23 U.S.C. 134; 49 U.S.C. 5303). MPOs must develop and maintain a Long-Range Transportation Plan and a Transportation Improvement Program, each updated every four years. MPOs serving urbanized areas with a population of 200,000 or more, designated as Transportation Management Areas (TMAs), are also required to maintain a Congestion Management Process (23 CFR 450.322).

Federal planning requirements also emphasize performance-driven, outcome based planning, first introduced under MAP-21 in 2012 and continued under the FAST Act and the Infrastructure Investment and Jobs Act (IIJA). This framework requires MPOs and states to establish measurable targets tied to national performance goals covering safety, infrastructure condition, system reliability, and freight movement (23 U.S.C. 150; 23 CFR 490), ensuring federal investments advance national transportation priorities.

National Transportation Planning Factors

Since the Intermodal Surface Transportation Efficiency Act of 1991 (ISTEA), Congress has identified key planning areas for MPOs and states to consider when developing multimodal transportation plans. MAP-21 established ten planning factors under 23 CFR 450.306 that remain in effect through the FAST Act and IIJA:

- Support the **economic vitality** of the metropolitan area, especially by enabling global competitiveness, productivity, and efficiency
- Increase the **safety** of the transportation system for motorized and non-motorized users
- Increase the **security** of the transportation system for motorized and non-motorized users
- Increase the **accessibility and mobility** of people and freight
- Protect and enhance the **environment**, promote energy conservation, improve quality of life, and promote consistency between transportation improvements and planned growth and economic development
- Enhance the **integration and connectivity** of the transportation system across and between modes for people and freight
- Promote efficient **system management and operation**
- Emphasize the **preservation** of the existing transportation system
- Improve the **resiliency and reliability** of the transportation system and reduce or mitigate stormwater impacts of surface transportation
- Enhance **travel and tourism**

Federal Performance Measures

Under MAP-21 and continued through the IIJA, MPOs and states must set targets tied to seven national goal areas:

1. Safety — reducing fatalities and serious injuries
2. Infrastructure condition — pavement and bridge condition ratings
3. System reliability — travel time consistency on highways and freight corridors
4. Freight movement — truck travel time reliability
5. CMAQ — traffic congestion and on-road mobile source emissions
6. Transit asset management — state of good repair for transit systems
7. Transit safety — fatalities, injuries, and safety events on transit

These are governed primarily under 23 CFR 490 and require states and MPOs to establish measurable targets and report progress regularly to FHWA and FTA.

Plan2050 Goals, Objectives, Performance Measures

The goals and objectives for Plan2050 build on the framework established for the region's previously adopted LRTP, Plan2045, and were affirmed through the MPO's Multimodal Mobility Plan in 2025. Rather than beginning from scratch, TCAMPO used the multimodal planning process as an opportunity to validate that the existing goals remained relevant to the region's evolving conditions, community priorities, and federal performance requirements. Guided by the previous public survey developed for the region's previous LRTP (Plan2045) and subsequent planning efforts, TCAMPO adopted the following goals and objectives:

A Safety:

Improve the safety of the transportation system for all people.

- A1 Enhance safety and comfort of bicycle and pedestrian facilities
- A2 Work to eliminate all serious injuries and fatalities resulting from crashes

B Environment/Land Use:

Reduce the negative impact the transportation system has on the natural and built environment.

- B1 Address roadways prone to flooding and consider climate impacts in transportation planning prioritization and funding decisions.
- B2 Reduce transportation related pollutants.
- B3 Increase number and share of trips taken by shared and active transportation modes.
- B4 Assist and support localities as they perform land use planning regarding transportation investments that encourage walkable and transit-oriented communities.
- B5 Minimize impacts of transportation system on natural resources and communities with a particular emphasis on Environmental Justice (EJ) populations

C Equity/Accessibility:

Improve equitable access through greater availability of mode choices that are affordable and efficient

- C1 Reduce trip lengths for all people with a focus on Environmental Justice (EJ) populations.
- C2 Increase access to jobs and community services via transit, walking, and biking for all people with a focus on EJ populations

D Economic Development:

Improve connectivity and mobility for strong economic vitality

- D1 Reduce peak period travel times.
- D2 Increase transportation investment which focuses on economic vitality.
- D3 Improve reliability and accessibility of travel to and within the regional activity centers.
- D4 Reduce freight bottlenecks.
- D5 Increase multimodal access to tourist destinations.

E Mobility:

Increase travel efficiency and mode choices by maintaining the transportation system in a state of good repair

- E1 Increase the percent of complete streets across the highway network to maximize use of available capacity.
- E2 Increase system efficiency through operational, transportation demand management (TDM), and technology-based solutions.
- E3 Improve system reliability across all modes.

Each goal in Plan2050 is supported by objectives that define what the region is working toward, including reducing highway congestion, improving system reliability, expanding equitable access to transit, and reducing fatalities and serious injuries. As shown in **Figure 1**, Plan2050 performance measures such as Travel Time Index (TTI), Peak Hours of Excessive Delay (PHED), percent of person-miles traveled on the Interstate/non-Interstate provide a quantitative basis for evaluating plan outcomes in alignment with federal requirements under 23 CFR 490.

Figure 2. Plan2050 Congestion Management Plan Performance Measures

Planning Process

The development of Plan2050 followed a process designed to meet federal requirements while remaining grounded on the region's priorities. The process followed multiple phases including data collection and existing conditions assessment, community and stakeholder engagement, scenario development and evaluation, project prioritization, and fiscal constraint analysis.

Data Collection and Conditions Assessment

TCAMPO began the planning process by establishing a comprehensive understanding of national and regional trends and forecasts (see Chapter 2: National and Regional Trends and Forecasts). This

was followed by an assessment of existing transportation conditions across the region, including an inventory of roadway network performance, bridge and pavement conditions, transit service coverage and ridership patterns, bicycle and pedestrian infrastructure, interregional travel, and freight movement corridors (see Chapter 3: Our Transportation System Today). Travel demand modeling, drawing on current and projected demographic and land use data from member jurisdictions and the Crater Planning District Commission, was used to forecast future conditions under a no-build scenario. This baseline served as the foundation against which future investment scenarios were evaluated.

Community and Stakeholder Engagement

Public and stakeholder engagement was conducted during the planning process in accordance with TCAMPO's Public Participation Plan and Title VI requirements. Outreach efforts were designed to reach a broad cross-section of the region's residents, including populations that are traditionally underserved or underrepresented in transportation planning processes. Engagement activities included public meetings, online surveys, and coordination with local jurisdiction staff. Input gathered through these efforts informed the development of plan goals, the identification of transportation needs, and the evaluation of investment priorities.

Scenario Development and Evaluation

TBD

Project Identification and Prioritization

Transportation needs and candidate projects were identified through a combination of local jurisdiction input, travel demand modeling outputs, and asset management data. Projects were evaluated using factors related to safety, mobility and congestion, accessibility and equity, environment, and economic development. This evaluation informed how projects were ranked and advanced for potential inclusion in the financially constrained plan.

Fiscal Constraint

Federal regulations require that the LRTP be fiscally constrained, meaning the total cost of projects and programs included in the Plan must not exceed the funding reasonably expected to be available over the planning horizon. TCAMPO developed revenue projections based on historical federal, state, and regional funding allocations, anticipated formula program apportionments, and guidance from VDOT, DRPT, and the Central Virginia Transportation Authority (CVTA) on projected funding levels. Projects were organized into funding tiers reflecting the degree of certainty associated with available revenues, ensuring that the Plan presents a realistic and implementable program of investments rather than an unconstrained wish list.

Interagency and Regional Coordination

Throughout the planning process, TCAMPO coordinated with VDOT, DRPT, PAT, and RRTPO. This coordination ensured consistency with statewide transportation plans and investment programs, addressed cross-boundary travel needs, and fulfilled the consultation procedures established under the Memoranda of Agreement executed pursuant to 23 CFR 450.310. Fort Gregg-Adams, RideFinders, and the National Park Service at Petersburg National Battlefield also contributed perspectives relevant to their roles in the regional transportation system.

Relationship to Other Plans, Reports, and Studies

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What We Heard: Stakeholder Involvement and Public Outreach

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